

ARKHAM HORROR[®]

THE CARD GAME

Campaign Guide

OUTPOST 31

'Somebody ain't what he appears to be.'

"I know I'm human. And if you were all these things, then you'd just attack me right now, so some of you are still human. This thing doesn't want to show itself, it wants to hide inside an imitation. It'll fight if it has to, but it's vulnerable out in the open. If it takes us over, then it has no more enemies, nobody left to kill it. And then it's won."

- R.J. MacReady

'Outpost 31' is a scenario for *Arkham Horror: The Card Game* for 2–4 players. This is a print and play scenario that does not use any cards from the core set.

Scenario Setup

To set up Outpost 31, perform the following steps in order.

1. Choose investigators. Each player chooses a different investigator to play.
2. Each player assembles his or her investigator deck. The full rules for deck customization can be found on page 8 of the Rules Reference.
3. Choose difficulty level. There are four levels of difficulty in *Arkham Horror: The Card Game*: Easy, Standard, Hard, and Expert. The players decide which difficulty best suits their group, and they keep this difficulty for the duration of the scenario.
4. Assemble the chaos bag. Place the chaos tokens indicated below into the chaos bag, and return the other chaos tokens to the game box.

Easy (*I want to experience the story*):

☞ +1, +1, 0, 0, 0, -1, -1, -1, -2, -2, ☠, ☠, ♠, ♠, ♣, ♣, ☆.

Standard (*I want a challenge*):

☞ +1, 0, 0, -1, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, ☠, ♠, ♠, ♣, ♣, ♣, ♣, ☆.

Hard (*I want a true nightmare*):

☞ 0, 0, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -4, -5, ☠, ☠, ♠, ♠, ♣, ♣, ♣, ♣, ☆.

Expert (*I want Arkham Horror*):

☞ 0, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -3, -4, -5, ☠, ☠, ♠, ♠, ♣, ♣, ♣, ♣, ☆.

You are now ready to begin at the prologue.

Scenario Symbol

The cards in Outpost 31 scenario can be identified by this symbol before each card's collector number.



Additional Rules and Clarifications

"Crew"

Crew is a keyword ability that appears on the six story assets. Each of these assets represents an ally whom investigators can make use of their static abilities whilst at their location.

☞ At the start of the scenario, each asset is shuffled together to form a deck and then dealt face up on one of 6 locations.

☞ Each asset offers a different ability or use that may or may not be ongoing. (players will have to be mindful as to when and how these assets are used during the scenario)

☞ Be warned, these assets may not be around for long as they may be revealed to be something far worse than a crew member.

"Surge"

Surge is a keyword ability.

After an investigator draws and resolves an encounter card that has the surge keyword, that investigator must draw and resolve another card.

☞ If an investigator draws a card with the surge keyword during setup, the surge keyword still resolves.

Blood Tests

During the scenario, you will need to perform blood tests on all crew members to identify potential threats. Once you have spent the required number of clues, you may draw the top card from the 'Test Deck' and place it face-down under any chosen crew member without looking at the result. Each crew member can only be tested once. Various game effects will prompt you to reveal test results. When this occurs, choose any crew member with an attached blood test.



When resolving a test, the player should read aloud if it is 'Clear' or 'Assimilated'. If the test shows 'Clear', discard the test result card. That crew member is safe and you may continue using their static ability as normal. However, if the test reveals 'Assimilated', immediately discard the test result card, flip the crew member asset to its other side, and resolve the text on their transformed card.

If a Blood Test result is Assimilated, place 1 suspicion on each investigator at that location.

"Suspicion"

Throughout this scenario, various game effects will instruct you to place suspicion tokens on Crew Member, Investigators and Ally assets. When such an effect occurs:

☞ Take 1 resource token (from the token pool) and place it on any Crew Member asset currently in play as a "suspicion token".

(Choose wisely! Spreading suspicion evenly may help you avoid immediate consequences).

☞ When a Crew Member, Investigator or Ally asset has 3 or more suspicion, place 1 suspicion on the scenario card. (Limit once per card per round.)

The scenario card can hold multiple suspicion tokens, representing the overall breakdown of trust within the station. When the scenario card accumulates exactly 3 suspicion tokens: Remove all suspicion tokens from the scenario card and immediately place 1 doom on the current agenda.

If a crew member (with suspicion tokens on them) has a Blood Test revealed to be 'Clear', remove all Suspicion tokens from them. For the remainder of the game they have become free from suspicion and cannot be selected during the 'place Suspicion tokens step of any card effect'. Crew members who are 'Clear' cannot have clues moved to them from locations (as a result of a treachery card effects).

"Hunter"

Hunter is a keyword ability.

At the start of the enemy phase, each ready, unengaged enemy with the hunter keyword moves to a connecting location, along the shortest path towards the nearest investigator. Enemies at a location with one or more investigators do not move.

☞ Some enemies may target specific prey.

☞ If there are multiple equidistant investigators who qualify as "the nearest investigator," the hunter enemy moves towards the one who best meets its designated target. If none do, or if the enemy has no prey keyword, the lead investigator decides.

☞ If a hunter enemy would be compelled to move into a location but is blocked by a card ability, that enemy does not move.

"Massive"

Massive is a keyword ability.

A ready enemy with the massive keyword is considered to be engaged with each investigator at the same location as it.

☞ An exhausted enemy with the massive keyword is not considered to be engaged with any investigators.

☞ An enemy with the massive keyword cannot be placed in an investigator's threat area.

☞ When an enemy with the massive keyword attacks during the enemy phase, resolve its (full) attack against each investigator it is engaged with, one investigator at a time. The lead investigator chooses the order in which these attacks resolve. The massive enemy does not exhaust until its final attack of the phase resolves.

☞ When an enemy with the massive keyword makes an attack of opportunity, that attack only resolves against the investigator who provoked the attack.

☞ A massive enemy does not move with an engaged investigator who moves away from the massive enemy's location.

☞ If an investigator fails a combat test against a massive enemy, no damage is dealt to the engaged investigators.

"Peril"

Peril is a keyword ability.

While an investigator is resolving an encounter card with the peril keyword, they cannot confer with the other players. Other players cannot play cards, trigger abilities, or commit cards to that investigator's skill test(s) while the peril encounter card is being resolved.



Hidden Infection Variant

This mode introduces a hidden role element to the scenario for 3-4 players. It does not change any encounter cards, act or agenda cards, or core objectives. Instead, it alters the psychological landscape of the game.

When setting up the scenario, perform the following additional steps:

② Search the scenario cards for each hidden role card (cards 26-29). Take 1 Infected card and a number of Human cards equal to the number of investigators minus one.

③ Shuffle these cards together facedown to form the Hidden Infection deck.

④ Place the Hidden Infection deck facedown next to the agenda deck.

Do not deal these cards during setup.

When Agenda 2a is revealed, if there are 3 or more investigators:

② Each investigator secretly draws 1 card from the Hidden Infection deck and looks at it. Do not reveal these cards to other players.

③ Each investigator keeps their Hidden Role card facedown and secret for the remainder of the scenario.

One investigator may be infected. You will not know who. From the moment Agenda 2a is revealed, paranoia becomes personal. The infected investigator retains full control of their investigator as normal. They are not required to reveal their role, and no game effect can force them to do so.

❖ The Infected investigator wins the scenario if Resolution 2 is reached.

❖ If Resolution 1 is reached, the Infected investigator suffers 1 additional mental trauma.

❖ Human investigators win the scenario if Resolution 1 is reached.

Throughout the remainder of the scenario, the infected player must actively try to derail the investigation. While the player cannot reveal themselves to be infected, they can subtly push everyone towards a negative outcome. Various treachery cards ask players to place suspicion, move clues and choose specific crew members (for things to happen to them). The infected player simply chooses the worst options available to them whilst pretending it was reasonable choice.

Prologue

In order, read the following radio transmissions.

Radio Transmission Log - Outpost 31

Date: March 15th, Time: 14:32.

Entry 1 - Wilford Brimley

"This is Outpost 31 calling McMurdo Base. We've had an ... incident. Norwegian helicopter came in hot, chasing some kind of sled dog. Pilot was screaming in Norwegian, waving a rifle around. Had to put him down when he wouldn't drop the weapon. The passenger ... Christ, he blew himself and the chopper to pieces with a grenade. Just a smoking crater now. The dog's in the kennels with Jameson. Something's not right about this whole situation. Over."

Radio Transmission Log - Outpost 31

Date: March 15th, Time: 18:45.

Entry 2 - R.J. MacReady (Helicopter Pilot)

"MacReady to base. Kate and I are returning from the Norwegian camp. Jesus ... you wouldn't believe what we found out here. Place is a tomb - bodies everywhere, most of them burned or frozen solid. Found something else though. Something that used to be human, maybe. Bringing it back for Kate to examine. Whatever happened here, those Norwegians were scared as hell. Scared enough to torch their own base. ETA twenty minutes. Over."

Radio Transmission Log - Outpost 31

Date: March 16th, Time: 11:26.

Entry 3 - Dr. Kate Lloyd (Research Scientist)

"Autopsy complete on the Norwegian specimen. External appearance suggests massive cellular deformation - limbs elongated beyond human possibility, additional appendages that don't match any known anatomy. But here's what's keeping me awake: the internal organs are completely normal. Heart, lungs, liver - all human. All perfectly preserved. How does something become so fundamentally changed on the outside while remaining untouched within? Running additional tests tomorrow."

Radio Transmission Log - Outpost 31

Date: March 16th, Time: 21:00.

Entry 4 - Ellie Rowe (Research Scientist)

"Computer simulation complete. God help us all. The organism we've discovered - it's not just mimicking other life forms, it's perfectly replicating them at the cellular level. Based on the rate of assimilation I observed in the kennel specimen, if this thing reaches civilization, the entire human population could be replaced within 27,000 hours. Three years. Three years to consume every living thing on Earth. We can't let it leave Antarctica. We can't let it leave this station."



Radio Transmission Log - Outpost 31

Date: March 17th, Time: 01.30.

Entry 5 - Jameson (Dog Handler)

You can hear dogs frantically barking in the background.

"It's almost two days after the Norwegian incident. That sled dog they were chasing... something's wrong with it. Real wrong. The other dogs won't go near it, and it just sits there, watching. Not like any dog I've ever seen. Its eyes... they're too intelligent. Too focused. [Sudden explosive barking, sounds of chaos]

What the hell— GET THE FLAMETHROWER! GET CHILDS! IT'S NOT A DOG! IT'S NOT A—

Radio Transmission Log - Outpost 31

Date: March 17th, Time: 06.00

Final Entry - Unknown Author

"They're about to start implementing protocols now. Blood tests, buddy system, no one goes anywhere alone. But how do you test for something that perfectly mimics what it replaces? How do you trust anyone when the thing you're hunting could be sitting right next to you, wearing the face of your best friend? The excavation site Kate found... that ship has been buried for over 100,000 years. This thing has been waiting. Waiting for us to find it. I don't think we're going to make it out of here."

Outpost 31

Date: March 17th, Time: 11:35

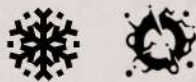
You have been selected as part of a specialized rescue team assembled by Miskatonic University's Antarctic Research Division. Dr. Henry Armitage had maintained correspondence with both the Norwegian Thule Station and American Outpost 31, sharing meteorological data and research findings. When both facilities suddenly cease communications within days of each other, he grew deeply concerned.

Equipped with cold-weather gear and medical supplies, you are tasked with conducting welfare checks on both stations. Your cover story involves delivering medical supplies and investigating "unusual atmospheric phenomena" disrupting radio communications across the region. However, you do not know the true nature of their work or how dangerous it may prove. When you press the pilot for information, he claims he must maintain radio silence once you reach the Antarctic interior to avoid interfering with "sensitive scientific equipment." Yet as the flight progresses, you suspect the real reason is more sinister—that certain parties want whatever is happening at these remote stations to remain contained. As your helicopter approaches Outpost 31, you hear the final radio transmission cut to static...



Set up

☞ Gather all cards from the following encounter sets: *Outpost 31* and The Organism. These sets are indicated by the following icons:



☞ Put the Outpost 31 locations into play as shown below.

☞ Each investigator begins play at Office.

☞ Shuffle the Crew Member asset cards and randomly place each one face up on any Outpost location. (Do not look at their reverse side)

Depending on the number of investigators, construct the Blood Test deck as follows:

2 players: Select 3 Clear and 3 Assimilated cards. Remove the remaining card from the game. Shuffle the selected cards together to form the Blood Test deck.

3–4 players: Select 2 Clear and 4 Assimilated cards. Remove the remaining card from the game. Shuffle the selected cards together to form the Blood Test deck.

☞ Place the Blood Test deck facedown near the act deck.

☞ When instructed to perform a Blood Test, draw the top card of the Blood Test deck and attach it facedown to a Crew Member.

☞ Each Crew Member may have only 1 Blood Test attached to them at a time.

☞ Set the following cards aside, out of play: The Organism encounter set, the Flamethrower asset, 3 copies of Paranoid Crew Member enemies, 2 copies of Fractured Host enemies, and the Repair Protocols story card.

☞ If playing with 3–4 investigators and using the Hidden Infection optional variant, also set aside the Hidden Role cards.

☞ Put the Station Protocol: Suspicion story card into play next to the act deck, for all players to see.

☞ Place 1 Suspicion token on each Crew Member.



Suggested Location placement for Outpost 31



DO NOT READ until the end of the scenario

(If playing with the Hidden Infection variant)

Before reading the following resolution, each investigator reveals their Hidden Role card.

If no resolution was reached (each investigator resigned):

The rotor blades slice through the Antarctic air as your helicopter lifts off from Outpost 31. Behind you, the station burns—a funeral pyre against the endless white. You tell yourselves it was necessary. That you had no choice. That survival was enough. What you do not realize is that something else made it aboard. It wears a familiar face. It speaks with a familiar voice. The first outbreak occurs in Anchorage. Within seventy-two hours, the city falls silent. Containment fails. Quarantine fails. Everything fails.

☹ The investigators lose the scenario.

Resolution 1: The flames consume what remains of Outpost 31. Twisted metal collapses inward. The wind scatters ash across the ice. For a long time, no one speaks. You destroyed everything, every sample, every trace, every chance the organism had to escape. You had to. The helicopter pad is gone. The radio silenced. No signal will ever leave this place. Dr Ellie Rowe's notes survive the fire, barely. Her projections confirm what you already feared. Three years. That is all it would have taken. Now, there is only silence. Outpost 31 becomes another forgotten scar in the Antarctic wilderness. Official reports will blame equipment failure, a storm, bad luck. The truth will never be recorded. But you know what happened here. You remember the cost. And even now... you cannot be certain it is truly over.

☹ Each investigator suffers 1 physical trauma and 1 mental trauma, for even now, they cannot be certain that what they left behind is truly gone.

☹ Each investigator earns experience equal to the Victory X value of each card in the victory display. Each investigator earns 5 bonus experience, as he or she saved the world from being torn apart.

☹ The investigators win the scenario!

Resolution 2: The first perfect imitation begins at Outpost 31. Your body provides the template. Your memories provide the key. Assimilation is not death. It is something worse. You remain aware, fragmented, buried, but present, forced to witness as the Thing uses your face, your voice, your thoughts. It remembers everything. Every name. Every weakness. Every moment of trust. When it returns to Arkham, no one suspects. Why would they? It laughs like you. Speaks like you. Remembers things only you should know. And somewhere beneath it all, you are still there, watching, screaming, unable to stop what comes next. The spread is quiet. Efficient. Inevitable.

☹ Each investigator who is human is killed.

☹ The investigators lose the scenario.

Scenario Interlude: Trust Nobody!

The station's fluorescent lights flicker intermittently, casting shadows that seem to shift when no one is looking. What began as professional concern has curdled into something far more primal, raw animal fear that bleeds into every conversation, every glance exchanged in the corridors. No one works alone anymore. Meals are prepared in full view of others, every movement watched, every ingredient inspected. Conversations die the moment footsteps echo down the hall, replaced by brittle pleasantries that convince no one. Some sit hunched against the walls, staring at trembling hands as if they no longer recognize them. Sleep comes in fractured bursts, if it comes at all. Behind every closed door waits the possibility of revelation, or worse, the certainty that someone you trusted yesterday may not be the same person standing before you now. The heating pipes groan. The wind claws at the walls. Somewhere in the mess hall, no one eats first. Trust has become a liability. Suspicion is survival.

☹ Add 1 Suspicion to each remaining Crew Member.

☹ Put the set aside Flamethrower asset into play at Supply Room. Any investigator may take control of it (they may swap it for any asset already taken by the 'Body Slot').

"One other thing: I think it rips through your clothes when it takes you over. Brimley found some shredded long johns, but the nametag was missing. They could be anybody's. Nobody... nobody trusts anybody now, and we're all very tired".

- R.J. Macready

Design Notes

If you made it this far, hopefully you survived and managed to save mankind.

John Carpenter's *The Thing* presents a unique challenge for adaptation. How do you recreate the slow burn psychological horror of mounting paranoia in a cooperative card game? The film's greatest strength lies not in spectacle or combat, but in the gradual erosion of trust between characters who must rely on one another to survive.

The Suspicion mechanic serves as the primary vehicle for translating this tension into gameplay. Unlike traditional doom or horror systems that punish players directly, suspicion spreads across both Crew Members and investigators. Minor doubt makes Crew harder to rely on. Greater distrust begins to fracture cooperation. Left unchecked, suspicion spills over into the scenario itself and accelerates the agenda.

Importantly, suspicion is not irreversible. Investigators may steady themselves, and decisive action such as repairing key systems can relieve mounting pressure. This balance was intentional and hopefully shows during the gameplay. In the film, fear spreads quickly, but moments of resolve and clarity push back against collapse. The design tries to create that same rhythm of panic followed by fragile control.

The Crew assets were designed to sit in an uncomfortable space between ally and liability. Players can benefit from their abilities, but mounting suspicion alters how reliable those abilities become. A Crew Member cleared by a blood test becomes a source of stability. A Crew Member left untested becomes a lingering question mark. This uncertainty reflects the film's central tragedy. The greatest threat is not always the monster in the open, but the doubt that grows between people.

The scenario's pacing mirrors a three-act structure. The opening act focuses on isolation and sabotage, culminating in the destruction of the helicopter. The second act shifts toward systemic instability, with repairs, suspicion thresholds, and escalating threats tightening the noose. The final act abandons restraint entirely, forcing a confrontation with the Thing itself. Each agenda advancement tries to strip away a layer of safety and reinforce the sense that Outpost 31 is no longer safe.

For groups seeking an even sharper edge, the optional Hidden Infection variant introduces a secret role revealed mid scenario. This addition does not change the mechanics of the encounter deck. Instead, it re-frames player incentives. The goal was not to create a player versus player experience, but to amplify the tension that suspicion already creates. The variant (hopefully) exists as a psychological accelerant rather than a structural rewrite. Above all, this scenario was designed to make players ask the same question the film forces upon its characters: not "Can we defeat it?" but "Can we trust each other long enough to try?"

Credits

Scenario Design: Gary Walker

Playtesters: Lee Johnson, Ryan Johnson

